

Strategic and Competitive Intelligence Project — Metro AG Digitalization

Scope

This project analyzes the digitalization of customer-facing services of Metro AG within the European HoReCa sector, focusing on the development and adoption of digital platforms (e-commerce, mobile applications, and data-driven tools), and evaluates how these capabilities influence Metro's competitive positioning against traditional and digital-native competitors over a 3–5 year horizon.

KIT 1 — Digital strategy and capabilities

Key intelligence topic: How developed and effective are Metro's digital customer-facing services in supporting its competitive strategy in the European HoReCa sector?

KIQs

- What digital services (e-commerce platforms, apps, data tools) does Metro currently offer to HoReCa customers?
- How have Metro's digital investments and capabilities evolved over the past 3–5 years?
- What functionalities and value-added services, such as personalization, analytics, and ordering tools, are integrated into Metro's digital platforms?
- How do these digital capabilities contribute to operational efficiency or customer experience?

Indicators

- Number and type of digital services offered, including e-commerce, apps, and analytics tools
- Frequency of digital feature updates or releases
- Investment signals in digitalization, such as capex and innovation mentions in reports
- Number of job postings related to digital roles, including data analysts, product managers, and AI roles
- Partnerships with technology providers

Data sources

Metro annual reports, Metro website and apps, LinkedIn job postings, and press releases

KIT 2 — Competitive positioning vs digital players

Key intelligence topic: How does Metro's digital offering compare to traditional wholesalers and digital-native competitors in delivering value to HoReCa customers?

KIQs

- Who are the main competitors offering digital services to HoReCa customers in Europe, both traditional and digital-native?
- How do competitors' digital platforms differ from Metro's in terms of features, usability, and service scope?
- What competitive advantages or gaps can be identified in Metro's digital offering?
- How are competitors investing in and expanding their digital capabilities?

Indicators

- Number of digital features per competitor platform
- Platform usability and functionality comparison
- Customer ratings of digital services across apps and websites
- Speed of digital innovation, including new features and launches
- Market visibility of competitors' digital initiatives

Data sources

Competitor websites and apps, App Store and Google Play reviews, industry reports, and news articles

Priority competitors

Based on the defined scope, the three most relevant competitor references are Selgros, Bidfood, and Choco, because they cover the traditional wholesale and digital-native dimensions most relevant to Metro's HoReCa-facing digital positioning in Europe.

KIT 3 — Customer adoption and value capture

Key intelligence topic: To what extent are HoReCa customers adopting Metro's digital services, and how does this influence value creation and capture?

KIQs

- What is the level of adoption and usage of Metro's digital platforms among HoReCa customers?
- What are the main drivers and barriers influencing customer adoption of digital services?
- How do customers perceive the value and usability of Metro's digital tools through reviews and feedback?
- How does digital adoption impact customer loyalty, purchasing behavior, or revenue generation?

Indicators

- App downloads or usage metrics
- Frequency of digital channel usage
- Customer satisfaction and sentiment
- Recurring complaints or praised features
- Impact on customer loyalty and retention signals

Data sources

App reviews, online forums, surveys, and customer testimonials

KIT 4 — Emerging trends and threats

Key intelligence topic: What emerging digital trends and technologies could reshape competition in the wholesale HoReCa sector over the next 3–5 years?

KIQs

- What emerging digital technologies, such as AI, automation, and platforms, are being adopted in the wholesale and HoReCa ecosystem?
- Are new digital-native entrants or platforms targeting Metro's customer segment?
- What strategic moves, including partnerships, acquisitions, and innovations, are competitors making in digitalization?
- What early signals indicate potential disruption in the sector, such as changing customer expectations and new business models?

Indicators

- Number of new digital entrants in the market
- Investment trends in food and wholesale tech startups
- Frequency of keywords such as AI, automation, and platforms in news
- Strategic moves, including partnerships and acquisitions
- Changes in customer expectations, especially around speed and convenience

Data sources

News databases, startup platforms, industry reports, and competitor announcements